

What is Digital Citizenship?

Learning Objectives

- Define digital citizenship and its importance in modern life
- Identify the core principles of being a responsible digital citizen
- Connect digital citizenship concepts to real-life village community values

Engage (5-7 minutes)

In our village, we follow unwritten rules: respect elders, help neighbors, keep promises. Digital citizenship applies these same values to the online world — how we behave, treat others, and use technology responsibly, just like being a good member of our village community.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Students discuss what makes someone a good citizen in their village: honesty, respect, helping others. They compare these to online behavior — being honest on social media, respecting others' posts, and reporting harmful content, like a digital version of village community values.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Digital citizenship means using technology responsibly, ethically, and safely. It includes five core principles: respect (treating others well online), educate (learning about technology), protect (keeping yourself and others safe), responsibility (accountability for actions), and etiquette (polite online behavior). Like village values that guide community life, these principles guide our digital lives.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Students create a "Digital Village Pledge" — rules they'll follow online, based on village values. Like a village promise that everyone agrees to keep, their pledge commits them to responsible digital behavior.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Can students define digital citizenship in their own words? Can they identify at least three core principles? Do they see the connection between village values and digital behavior?